

Mesam E Tamaar Khan

Security Researcher

[linkedin.com/in/mesam-tamaar-khan](https://www.linkedin.com/in/mesam-tamaar-khan) • github.com/mesametamaarkhan • mesamtamaark@gmail.com • +92 3265635009

Executive Summary

Computer Science graduate specializing in offensive security, with hands-on experience conducting client-facing penetration testing engagements across authentication, access control, and injection vulnerabilities. Findings rated using a NIST-aligned risk rating approach and vulnerability management lifecycle, with relevant controls mapped to ISO 27001 as part of formal, client-ready reports supporting compliance posture. Comfortable working independently through the full offensive security lifecycle: reconnaissance, exploitation, network pivoting, and post-exploitation, and communicating findings to both technical and non-technical stakeholders across Linux and Windows environments.

Education

Bachelor of Science in Computer Science

2022 – 2026

FAST National University of Computer and Emerging Sciences, Islamabad

Technical Skills

Offensive Security: Penetration Testing, Red Teaming, Vulnerability Assessment, Access Control Testing, Network Pivoting, Post-Exploitation, Web & Network App Testing

Security Tools: Burp Suite, Tenable Nessus, OWASP ZAP, Nmap, SQLMap, Gobuster, Wappalyzer, Metasploit, Wireshark, Hydra, Suricata, theHarvester

Governance, Risk & Compliance: NIST Risk Rating & Vulnerability Management Lifecycle, PTES, MITRE ATT&CK, ISO 27001 Control Mapping, OWASP Top 10, Findings Documentation & Remediation Guidance

Networking & Systems: TCP/IP, Firewall Configuration, Traffic Analysis & Packet Inspection, Linux Administration & Hardening, Windows Environments, Docker, Git

Programming: Python, JavaScript, SQL, Go, Rust

Experience

Penetration Tester, Aartec

Jul 2026 – Aug 2026

- Delivered a client engagement penetration testing a production website and the Contapp application, testing authentication and session handling, access control, and injection vulnerabilities using Burp Suite, Nessus, OWASP ZAP, Nmap, and SQLMap.
- Rated findings using a NIST-aligned risk rating approach and vulnerability management lifecycle, mapped relevant controls to ISO 27001, and delivered a client-ready report with remediation guidance supporting the application's compliance posture.

Software Engineer Intern, Aartec

May 2026 – Jul 2026

- Built a contact management mobile application solo, end to end, using Flutter and Supabase; shipped to production and in active use by the Aartec team.

Web Development Intern, Pakistan Software Export Board (PSEB)

Nov 2024 – Jan 2025

- Developed full-stack features and integrated REST APIs for a mentorship and freelancing platform in a collaborative, team-based environment.

Projects

SafeHarbor – Multi-Stage Security Assessment

- Conducted a controlled, multi-stage offensive security assessment across containerized systems in an isolated lab, following PTES methodology: reconnaissance, service enumeration, vulnerability analysis, network pivoting between compromised hosts, and post-exploitation, with techniques mapped to MITRE ATT&CK and the full attack path and remediation documented in a formal report.

Linux System Hardening Lab

- Hardened a Linux system end to end, including SSH configuration (key-based auth, disabled root login), firewall rules, and privilege management, validating each change against common misconfiguration checks to reduce attack surface.
- Applied CIS Benchmark-style controls to lock down services, file permissions, and user privileges, and used auditd logging to verify each hardening step held under simulated attack attempts.

Auto-Sentry – Agentic Network Detection & Response System (Final Year Project)

- Designed a multi-agent NDR platform, with planner, detection, and response agents coordinated through a graph-based pipeline, routing events through rule-based and ML-oriented anomaly detection and surfacing results as incident traces on a dashboard.
- Built the response agent to auto-trigger containment actions (host isolation, rule updates) on high-confidence detections, cutting manual triage steps for common incident types.

Certifications & Training

- AWS Academy Cloud Foundations, Completed April 2026
- Google Cybersecurity Professional Certificate, Completed September 2026